Michael **Noetel**

Associate Professor · The University of Queensland
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Summary

Michael Noetel works to reduce the most serious risks from artificial intelligence. His research maps the ways AI could go wrong, measures how much risk the public is willing to accept, and finds where experts agree and disagree on what to do about it. He is an Associate Professor at the University of Queensland, a Research Affiliate at MIT, and Chair of Effective Altruism Australia.

Select AI Governance Contributions

- **SARA Project**: Led the Survey of Assessing Risks from AI, which informed Australia's Safe and Responsible AI in Australia discussion paper.
- **AI Risk Repository**: Co-authored repository of AI risk pathways (airisk.mit.edu), cited in the International AI Safety Report (2024).
- **Field-building**: Facilitated three cohorts of the AGI Safety Fundamentals Governance Course (BlueDot Impact) and supervise graduate research on frontier evals, AI literacy, AI consciousness, and public risk perception.

Teaching & Engagement Impact

- **Award-winning educator**: 9 national & institutional awards, incl. Australian Award for University Teaching & Vice-Chancellor's Award for Excellence. Mean student rating 4.8/5 across 2,390 students.
- **Public science communicator**: 10 *Conversation* articles (250K+ reads); media interviews for CNN, BBC, ABC, PBS NewsHour, The Times, including TV and live radio; invited to brief federal parliamentarians.
- **Chair**, Effective Altruism Australia since 2021 – stewarding AU$7.5M+/yr to cost-effective global-health and climate programs.

Research Excellence

- **High-impact evidence synthesis**: Lead author, network meta-analysis of exercise for depression (*BMJ*, Altmetric > 1,400; 100M+ media reach). Publications in his fields' top journals: *Nature Human Behaviour*, *Psychological Bulletin*, *Review of Educational Research*.
- **Competitive funding**: Chief Investigator on AU$3.7M Category 1 grants (NHMRC, MRFF, ARC).
- **Transparent & truth-seeking**: Embed pre-registration, open data/code; lead multi-institution teams using Agile & Scrum.
- **Metrics of excellence** (Web of Science): **2,960** citations; h-index **25**; m-index **3.5** (>2 = 'outstanding scientist'); **40.4%** of papers in top-10% most-cited; mean CNCI **3.93**, so his work is cited almost 4× the world average (1.0).

Skills

Evidence synthesis	Systematic reviews, Meta-analyses, Expert elicitation (e.g., Delphi)
Leadership	Agile project leadership, Stakeholder engagement, Board governance
Communication	Video production, Media engagement, Policy briefs, Knowledge translation
Technical	R, Agentic AI, Git, OSF, Data analysis, Reproducible workflows

Education

Doctor of Philosophy — Australian Catholic University
Institute for Positive Psychology and Education — 2019

Masters of Applied Psychology — The University of Queensland
2010

Bachelor of Science (Advanced, Honours) — University of Sydney
Double Major: Psychology; Computational Science — 2008

Academic Experience

Associate Professor — The University of Queensland
School of Psychology — 2025–Present

Affiliate Researcher — Massachusetts Institute of Technology
FutureTech — 2025–Present

Senior Lecturer — The University of Queensland
School of Psychology — 2022–2024

Senior Lecturer — Australian Catholic University
School of Health and Behavioural Sciences — 2020–2022

Research Fellow (Secondment; .4 FTE) — Australian Catholic University
Institute for Positive Psychology and Education — 2018–2019

Lecturer — Australian Catholic University
School of Health and Behavioural Sciences — 2015–2019

Accreditations

Senior Fellow, Higher Education Academy (SFHEA) — AdvanceHE
2020–Present

Registered Psychologist — AHPRA
2012–Present

Board Approved Supervisor — AHPRA
2015–Present

Awards

Young Tall Poppy Science Award (Queensland) — 2026
Australian Institute of Policy & Science

Alumni Excellence Award — 2025
Emmanuel College, The University of Queensland

Vice-Chancellor's Award for Excellence in Teaching — 2021
Australian Catholic University

Vice-Chancellor's Staff Excellence Award: Research & Research Partnership — 2021
Australian Catholic University – iPLAY Team

Excellence and Innovation in Public Health Education and Research (Team) — 2021
CAPHIA – iPLAY Team

Citation for Outstanding Contributions to Student Learning — 2020
Australian Awards for University Teaching

Best Presentation in Educational Technology — 2020
CQUniversity

Citations for Outstanding Contributions to Student Learning — 2019
Australian Catholic University

Citations (Early Career) for Outstanding Contributions to Student Learning — 2015
Australian Catholic University

Publications (53 total; 2,960 citations; h-index: 25)

Swaryandini, et al. (2026). Bounded Rationality in Career Choices: How Cognitive Biases Appear in Adolescent Career Exploration
Journal of Career Development

Vasconcellos, et al. (2025). Electronic Screen Use and Children's Socioemotional Problems: A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis of Longitudinal Studies
Psychological Bulletin — **27 citations** | **CNCI: 19.38** | ⋆ **Top 1% cited (ESI)**

Gaba, et al. (2025). Reallocating Time Between 24-h Movement Behaviors for Obesity Management Across the Lifespan: A Pooled Data Meta-Analysis of More Than 9800 Participants from Seven Countries
Sports Medicine

Lubans, et al. (2025). Scalable physical activity intervention for youth with disability: Burn 2 Learn adapted cluster randomized controlled trial
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity

Noetel, et al. (2025). Effects of a school-based physical activity intervention on children with intellectual disability: a cluster randomized trial
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity — **CNCI: 1.99**

Swaryandini, et al. (2025). Systematic review and meta-analysis of educational approaches to reduce cognitive biases among students
Nature Human Behaviour — **CNCI: 1.49**

Wallace, et al. (2025). Expert-derived recommendations for designing and facilitating tabletop crisis exercises: A Delphi study
Safety Science

Wang, et al. (2025). Cost-effectiveness of support for health professionals to implement physical activity promotion: a protocol for within-trial and modelled economic evaluations of the PROMOTE-PA effectiveness-implementation hybrid trial
Bmj Open

Wilhite, et al. (2025). Movement Mediates the Relationship Between Socioeconomic Position and Socioemotional Outcomes in Youth
Journal of Physical Activity & Health

Maher, et al. (2025). Improving physical activity and screen time in Australian Outside School Hours Care: Study protocol
Pediatric Research

Noetel, et al. (2024). Effect of exercise for depression: systematic review and network meta-analysis of randomised controlled trials
bmj — **398 citations** | **CNCI: 38.51** | ⋆ **Top 1% cited (ESI)**

Sanders, et al. (2024). An umbrella review of the benefits and risks associated with youths' interactions with electronic screens
Nature Human Behaviour — **107 citations** | **CNCI: 4.14** | ⋆ **Top 1% cited (ESI)**

Guo, et al. (2024). Harnessing Artificial Intelligence in Generative Content for enhancing motivation in learning
Learning and Individual Differences — **14 citations** | **CNCI: 4.04**

Verdonschot, et al. (2024). Development and evaluation of the Capability, Opportunity, and Motivation to deliver Physical Activity in School Scale (COM-PASS)
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity

Baldwin, et al. (2024). Promotion of Physical Activity by Health Professionals (PROMOTE-PA): protocol for effectiveness outcomes in a hybrid type I effectiveness-implementation cluster randomised controlled trial
Bmj Nutrition, Prevention & Health

Ferber, et al. (2024). Does the Apple Fall Far From the Tree? A Meta-Analysis Linking Parental Factors to Children's Intrinsic and Extrinsic Goals
Psychological Bulletin

Ahmadi, et al. (2023). A Classification System for Teachers' Motivational Behaviors Recommended in Self-Determination Theory Interventions
Journal of Educational Psychology — **371 citations** | **CNCI: 50.11** | ⋆ **Top 1% cited (ESI)**

Wilhite, et al. (2023). Combinations of Physical Activity, Sedentary Behavior, and Sleep Duration and Their Associations With Physical, Psychological, and Educational Outcomes in Children and Adolescents: A Systematic Review
American Journal of Epidemiology — **143 citations** | **CNCI: 5.21** | ⋆ **Top 1% cited (ESI)**

Gallardo-Gomez, et al. (2023). Optimal dose and type of physical activity to improve functional capacity and minimise adverse events in acutely hospitalised older adults: a systematic review with dose-response network meta-analysis of randomised controlled trials
British Journal of Sports Medicine — **41 citations** | **CNCI: 2.46**

Gallardo-Gomez, et al. (2023). Exercise to treat psychopathology and other clinical outcomes in schizophrenia: A systematic review and meta-analysis
European Psychiatry — **23 citations** | **CNCI: 1.12**

Noetel, et al. (2023). Prediction Versus Explanation in Educational Psychology: a Cross-Theoretical Approach to Using Teacher Behaviour to Predict Student Engagement in Physical Education
Educational Psychology Review — **17 citations**

Wilhite, et al. (2023). Socioeconomic position as a predictor of youth's movement trajectory profiles between ages 10 and 14 years
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity — **CNCI: 1.25**

Parker, et al. (2023). School Socioeconomic Status Context and Social Adjustment in Children
Developmental Psychology

Fasugba, et al. (2023). Evaluating remote facilitation intensity for multi-national translation of nurse-initiated stroke protocols (QASC Australasia): a protocol for a cluster randomised controlled trial
Implementation Science

Gallardo-Gomez, et al. (2022). Optimal dose and type of exercise to improve cognitive function in older adults: A systematic review and bayesian model-based network meta-analysis of RCTs
Ageing Research Reviews — **206 citations** | **CNCI: 5.2** | ⋆ **Top 1% cited (ESI)**

Noetel, et al. (2022). Multimedia Design for Learning: An Overview of Reviews With Meta-Meta-Analysis
Review of Educational Research — **94 citations** | **CNCI: 2.27**

Lubans, et al. (2022). Scale-up of the Internet-based Professional Learning to help teachers promote Activity in Youth (iPLAY) intervention: a hybrid type 3 implementation-effectiveness trial
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity

Kable, et al. (2022). Time-efficient physical activity intervention for older adolescents with disability: rationale and study protocol for the Burn 2 Learn adapted (B2La) cluster randomised controlled trial
Bmj Open

Noetel, et al. (2021). Video Improves Learning in Higher Education: A Systematic Review
Review of Educational Research — **210 citations** | **CNCI: 5.48** | ⋆ **Top 1% cited (ESI)**

Vella, et al. (2021). An Intervention for Mental Health Literacy and Resilience in Organized Sports
Medicine & Science in Sports & Exercise — **93 citations** | **CNCI: 7.13**

Lubans, et al. (2021). Time-efficient intervention to improve older adolescents' cardiorespiratory fitness: findings from the 'Burn 2 Learn' cluster randomised controlled trial
British Journal of Sports Medicine — **71 citations** | **CNCI: 5.9**

Hartwig, et al. (2021). School-based interventions modestly increase physical activity and cardiorespiratory fitness but are least effective for youth who need them most: an individual participant pooled analysis of 20 controlled trials
British Journal of Sports Medicine — **58 citations** | **CNCI: 2.07**

Donald, et al. (2021). Paths to the Light and Dark Sides of Human Nature: A Meta-Analytic Review of the Prosocial Benefits of Autonomy and the Antisocial Costs of Control
Psychological Bulletin — **44 citations** | **CNCI: 1.21**

Lee, et al. (2021). Influences on User Engagement in Online Professional Learning: A Narrative Synthesis and Meta-Analysis
Review of Educational Research — **30 citations** | **CNCI: 2.55**

Lonsdale, et al. (2021). Effect of a Scalable School-Based Intervention on Cardiorespiratory Fitness in Children A Cluster Randomized Clinical Trial
Jama Pediatrics — **27 citations** | **CNCI: 2.59**

Kennedy, et al. (2021). Evaluating the reach, effectiveness, adoption, implementation and maintenance of the Resistance Training for Teens program
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity — **26 citations** | **CNCI: 1.23**

Bradshaw, et al. (2021). Information Safety Assurances Increase Intentions to Use COVID-19 Contact Tracing Applications, Regardless of Autonomy-Supportive or Controlling Message Framing
Frontiers in Psychology — **25 citations** | **CNCI: 1.67**

Cruz, et al. (2021). The effects of the Australian bushfires on physical activity in children
Environment International — **17 citations**

Ahmadi, et al. (2021). A Systematic Review of Machine Learning for Assessment and Feedback of Treatment Fidelity
Psychosocial Intervention — **11 citations**

Parker, et al. (2020). The Intersection of Gender, Social Class, and Cultural Context: a Meta-Analysis
Educational Psychology Review — **54 citations** | **CNCI: 3.03**

Mavilidi, et al. (2020). Impact of the "Thinking while Moving in English" intervention on primary school children's academic outcomes and physical activity: A cluster randomised controlled trial
International Journal of Educational Research — **20 citations** | **CNCI: 1.63**

Eather, et al. (2020). Development and Evaluation of the High-Intensity Interval Training Self-Efficacy Questionnaire
Journal of Sport & Exercise Psychology — **16 citations**

Valkenborghs, et al. (2019). The Impact of Physical Activity on Brain Structure and Function in Youth: A Systematic Review
Pediatrics — **152 citations** | **CNCI: 5.45**

Noetel, et al. (2019). Mindfulness and acceptance approaches to sporting performance enhancement: a systematic review
International Review of Sport and Exercise Psychology — **125 citations**

Sanders, et al. (2019). Type of screen time moderates effects on outcomes in 4013 children: evidence from the Longitudinal Study of Australian Children
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity — **122 citations** | **CNCI: 4.32**

Beetham, et al. (2019). The effects of vigorous intensity exercise in the third trimester of pregnancy: a systematic review and meta-analysis
Bmc Pregnancy and Childbirth — **104 citations** | **CNCI: 2.65**

del Pozo-Cruz, et al. (2019). Joint physical-activity/screen-time trajectories during early childhood: socio-demographic predictors and consequences on health-related quality-of-life and socio-emotional outcomes
International Journal of Behavioral Nutrition and Physical Activity — **56 citations** | **CNCI: 2.18**

Leahy, et al. (2019). Feasibility and Preliminary Efficacy of a Teacher-Facilitated High-Intensity Interval Training Intervention for Older Adolescents
Pediatric Exercise Science — **51 citations** | **CNCI: 2.87**

Leahy, et al. (2019). School-based physical activity intervention for older adolescents: rationale and study protocol for the Burn 2 Learn cluster randomised controlled trial
Bmj Open — **24 citations** | **CNCI: 1.22**

Mavilidi, et al. (2019). Integrating physical activity into the primary school curriculum: rationale and study protocol for the "Thinking while Moving in English" cluster randomized controlled trial
Bmc Public Health — **20 citations**

Noetel, et al. (2019). Using genetic algorithms to abbreviate the Mindfulness Inventory for Sport: A substantive-methodological synthesis
Psychology of Sport and Exercise — **15 citations**

Vella, et al. (2018). Ahead of the game protocol: a multi-component, community sport-based program targeting prevention, promotion and early intervention for mental health among adolescent males
Bmc Public Health — **56 citations** | **CNCI: 2.36**

Lonsdale, et al. (2016). Scaling-up an efficacious school-based physical activity intervention: Study protocol for the 'Internet-based Professional Learning to help teachers support Activity in Youth' (iPLAY) cluster randomized controlled trial and scale-up implementation evaluation
Bmc Public Health — **30 citations** | **CNCI: 1.08**

Research Grants

AI Risk Index: Assessing influential organizations' responses to risks from AI 2025–2027
Subaward with MIT $663,766

Seeing the Bigger Picture: Exploring Children's Screen Time 2025–2026
NSW Dept of Education $341,307

Promotion of evidence-based physical activity for older adults and people with disabilities 2022–2025
NHMRC (PRC1: 2011157) $1,440,375

Prototyping a co-designed effective altruism program 2022–2023
Open Philanthropy $58,000

Effectiveness of school-based physical activity for adolescents with disability 2021–2023
MRFF (2007095) $736,399

Meta-review of institutional decision-making 2021–2022
EA Infrastructure Fund $39,654

Square eyes or all lies? Understanding children's exposure to screens 2020–2023
ARC Discovery (DP200101912) $658,544

PLAY for Inclusion – Teachers working with children with intellectual disability 2019–2020
Move It AUS $268,802

Engaging students during the early years of secondary school (iTEACH) 2016–2020
ARC Discovery (DP160102625) $590,000

Other grants 2018–2019
Sport Australia / NSW DoE / QAS $188,744

Media Coverage

Screen use and socio-emotional problems 2025
ABC News 24, Good Morning America, Nine News, National Newscorp

Risks from advanced artificial intelligence 2024–2026
ABC News, The Courier-Mail, Ten News, SmartCompany, The Conversation, The Conversation

Exercise for depression 2024
Altmetric: 95 news outlets, 1,500+ X posts, 15 YouTube creators, 5 Wikipedia pages. CNN, Good Morning America, PBS NewsHour, The Times, ABC Radio, The Australian, The Conversation, National Geographic

Effective altruism 2021
ABC Religion & Ethics, ABC Radio National, The Conversation

Videos in higher education 2020

Forbes, The Conversation

Invited Talks & Government Briefings

- **Government briefings**: Indonesian Ministry of Communication and Digital Affairs (2026); Ministry of Education, Republic of China – Taiwan (2025); Australian Depts of Industry, Science and Resources (2025), Education (2025), and Health, Disability and Ageing (2024).
- **Invited talks**: University of Pennsylvania, Master of Behavioral and Decision Sciences (2026); Universitas Indonesia (2025, 2026); EAGxAustralia keynotes/workshops (2019, 2022, 2023, 2025); Berkeley Effective Altruism (2022); HERDSA (2023); NASPSPA, Hawaii (2022); Prevention of Falls CRE (2022); Sports Medicine Australia (2020); AdvanceHE Teaching and Learning Conference (2021).

Research Supervision

PhD Primary Supervisor

A. Ahmadi, R. Vasconcellos, S. Griffith, G. Swaryandini, G. Hassed, M. Veron 2019–Present

PhD Associate Supervisor

B. Gibson, L. Hall, A. Urooj, E. Tremaine, D. Venini 2021–Present

Honours Primary Supervisor

43 Honours students from 2023–2026 2023–2026

Service & Engagement

Program Director (Academic), Master of Psychology — UQ School of Psychology
2023–2026

Director and Chairperson — Effective Altruism Australia
Stewarding AU$7.5M+/yr to cost-effective programs
2021–Present

Co-Lead, AI and Digital Psychology Stream — 34th International Congress of Psychology
Scientific Committee
2026–2028

Editorial Board Member — Sport, Exercise and Performance Psychology (APA)
2025–Present

College of Sport and Exercise Psychologists — Australian Psychological Society
National Treasurer (2015–2017; 2019–2021); NSW Chair (2015–2017); QLD Chair (2019–2021) 2015–2021